Assignment 1: Project Integration, Scope and Time Management

Submission Deadline: October 25, 2025. (11:00 PM)

Assignment Overview:
This assignment will test your ability to manage key elements of project planning such as business case development, scope management, change control, and time management. You will complete the tasks outlined below for your assigned project, which assumes a **two-month duration** and a **budget of $160,000**. The templates provided on the companion website for your textbook should be used as guides. Your goal is to apply project management principles to effectively plan and manage your project, including creating essential documents, using project management software, and addressing potential project changes

Assignment Tasks

1. Business Case (10%)

- **Task:** Prepare a business case for your assigned project using the provided template. Assume the whole project will take two months and cost $160,000.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Clarity and organization of business case
  - Realistic assumptions and justification of the project
  - Correct use of template

2. Project Charter (10%)

- **Task:** Develop a project charter following the template from your textbook. The project duration is two months, with a budget of $160,000.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Completeness and accuracy of the project charter
  - Proper alignment with the business case
  - Correct use of structure and elements from the template

3. Change Request (5%)

- **Task:** Prepare a change request for your project, using the template provided. Be creative in making up information to reflect a possible change scenario.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Creativity and practicality of the change request
  - Clear explanation of the change
  - Correct use of the change request template

Scope Management

4. Requirements Collection & Traceability Matrix (10%)

- **Task:** Document how you plan to collect requirements for your project. Create a requirements traceability matrix with at least five requirements.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Well-documented approach to collecting requirements
  - Completeness of the traceability matrix
  - Relevance of the five requirements

5. Project Scope Statement (10%)

- **Task:** Write a first version of the project scope statement using the template provided. Be specific in describing the project's deliverables, requirements, and scope. Include testing and training as part of the scope.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Clarity and specificity in describing deliverables
  - Proper inclusion of testing and training
  - Correct format and completeness of the scope statement

6. Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) (10%)

- **Task:** Develop a WBS for the project, breaking down work to Level 3 or 4 as appropriate. Provide the WBS in list format, ensuring alignment with the project charter and scope statement.
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- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Appropriate level of detail in the WBS
  - Logical structure and alignment with charter and scope
  - Proper format of WBS in list form

7. Gantt Chart Creation (5%)

- **Task:** Use the WBS to begin creating a Gantt chart using your choice of software. Do not enter durations or dependencies. Print the Gantt chart with the full Task Name column visible.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Proper structure and task organization
  - Clear display of tasks in the Gantt chart

8. Scope Validation & Change Control Strategy (5%)

- **Task:** Write a short description summarizing your strategy for scope validation and change control for the project.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Coherent and clear strategy for scope validation
  - Thoughtful approach to change control
  - Quality of writing and clarity of key points

Time Management

9. New Activities Proposal (5%)

- **Task:** Propose 3 to 5 additional activities that would help estimate resources and durations. Write a one-page paper explaining these activities.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Relevance of proposed activities to resource and time estimation
  - Clear and concise explanation of each activity

10. Milestone Identification (5%)

- **Task:** Identify at least eight milestones for the project using the SMART criteria. Write a short paper describing each milestone and how it adds tasks to the Gantt chart.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Well-defined milestones using SMART criteria
  - Clear explanation of milestone impact on Gantt chart and schedule

11. Updated Gantt Chart (10%)

- **Task:** Based on Tasks 9 and 10, update your Gantt chart with the new activities and milestones using project management software.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Correct integration of new activities and milestones
  - Clear and organized Gantt chart presentation

12. Task Durations & Dependencies (5%)

- **Task:** Estimate task durations and enter dependencies to fit the two-month project schedule. Print the Gantt chart and network diagram.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Accurate task duration estimates
  - Logical task dependencies
  - Correctly formatted Gantt chart and network diagram

13. Resource Assignment (10%)

- **Task:** Write a short paper summarizing how you would assign people to tasks from Tasks 9, 10, and 11. Include a table showing how many hours each person will work on each task.
- **Evaluation Criteria:**
  - Logical and efficient resource assignment
  - Well-organized table/matrix of hours per task
  - Clarity in writing and explanation

Evaluation Rubric Summary

Task	Weight	Criteria
1. Business Case	10%	Clarity, completeness, and realistic assumptions.
2. Project Charter	10%	Completeness, alignment with business case, and correct use of template.
3. Change Request	5%	Creativity, clarity, and template usage.
4. Requirements & Traceability Matrix	10%	Requirement collection approach and traceability matrix completeness.
5. Project Scope Statement	10%	Specificity in describing deliverables and correct format usage.
6. Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)	10%	Appropriate detail level and logical structure.
7. Gantt Chart Creation	5%	Clear task organization and proper format.
8. Scope Validation & Change Control	5%	Coherent strategy and quality of writing.
9. New Activities Proposal	5%	Relevance of proposed activities and clear explanation.
10. Milestone Identification	5%	Well-defined milestones using SMART criteria.
11. Updated Gantt Chart	10%	Proper integration of new activities and milestones.
12. Task Durations & Dependencies	5%	Accurate duration estimates and logical dependencies.
13. Resource Assignment	10%	Logical resource assignment and clear presentation of work hours.

Submission Deadline: October 25

Submit all documents, charts, and papers in the required formats through the course portal by the deadline.

References:

1. Kathy Schwalbe (2019). Information Technology Project Management, 9th Edition.Cengage
2. Textbook companion website, https://pmtexts.com/it-pm/
3. https://pmtexts.com/free-resources/free-templates/